PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineering Consultant | Detection Engineering | SIEM / XDR / SOAR / KQL

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a senior security engineering professional with over five years of deep, hands-on experience in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Extended Detection and Response (XDR), and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR). My specialisation is detection engineering: building, tuning and continuously improving detection logic aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework so that security operations centres (SOCs) catch real threats faster and generate fewer false positives. I am highly proficient in Kusto Query Language (KQL) for Microsoft Sentinel, and in CrowdStrike Falcon across its full suite of modules. I have delivered measurable improvements to detection fidelity and response times in a large, complex enterprise environment, and I bring strong customer-facing communication skills alongside the technical depth needed to advise organisations on their detection and response posture. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Detection Engineering:** SIEM detection rule design and tuning, Kusto Query Language (KQL) in Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Query Language (CQL), MITRE ATT&CK-aligned use-case development, Indicators of Compromise (IoC) and Indicators of Attack (IoA) creation, false-positive reduction
- **SIEM Platforms:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel, alert triage and investigation, log source onboarding and normalisation
- **XDR / EDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Falcon Prevent, Falcon Insight, Falcon Discover; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender; integrated XDR investigation workflows
- **SOAR:** Playbook design and automation, automated alert enrichment and triage, integration of SIEM alerts with ticketing and response workflows
- **SOC Operations:** L2/L3 alert triage and escalation, threat hunting, incident response (NIST 800-61), post-incident review and lessons-learned
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; risk-based prioritisation and remediation tracking
- **Identity Security:** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting; query-based investigation using KQL and CQL; automated detection testing
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Lead detection engineering across the SIEM and XDR stack: design, deploy and continuously refine detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL and in CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, maintaining alignment to the MITRE ATT&CK framework.
- Own the full SOC investigation lifecycle from alert triage through to containment and post-incident review, leveraging CrowdStrike Falcon EDR/XDR and Microsoft 365 Defender telemetry.
- Build and maintain SOAR playbooks for automated triage and enrichment, reducing mean time to respond for high-volume, lower-severity alerts and freeing analyst capacity for complex investigations.
- Conduct structured threat hunting campaigns using KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight to identify living-off-the-land techniques, lateral movement and persistence mechanisms not yet covered by existing detection rules.
- Act as the internal subject-matter expert for CrowdStrike Falcon, advising on policy configuration, detection tuning and new module deployments.

- Collaborate with engineering and identity teams to surface security signals from Microsoft Entra ID, Intune and cloud workloads into the central SIEM for holistic XDR coverage.
- Communicate risk findings and detection improvement recommendations to senior stakeholders in clear, non-technical language.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 – March 2025*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Supported a large-scale CrowdStrike Falcon EDR deployment across over 8,000 endpoints, configuring prevention policies, sensor deployment and integration with the SIEM platform.
- Authored a library of KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel targeting identity-based attack techniques including password spray, pass-the-hash and impossible-travel anomalies, improving detection coverage measurably.
- Performed daily SOC alert triage, investigating and escalating incidents using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and the integrated XDR console.
- Developed SOAR automation workflows to handle repetitive alert-handling tasks, integrating detection platforms with the incident ticketing system.
- Managed vulnerability scanning programmes using Tenable.io, AppCheck and Nessus; correlated findings with SIEM data to prioritise remediation of actively-exploited risks.
- Administered BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) and contributed to the continuous improvement of Conditional Access policies in Microsoft Entra ID.
- Supported the Cyber Essentials Plus accreditation process, mapping technical controls to framework requirements and resolving identified gaps.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 – March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech)

- Designed and implemented security monitoring controls across a cloud-first SaaS platform, including log collection, alerting and endpoint protection baselines.
- Authored PowerShell automation scripts to streamline security monitoring and infrastructure management, reducing manual operational overhead.
- Supported ISO 27001 framework alignment activities, contributing to the company's first formal information security management system (ISMS) implementation.
- Managed identity and access governance processes, applying least-privilege principles and conducting periodic access reviews.
- Performed internal vulnerability assessments and tracked remediation of identified weaknesses against agreed risk-acceptance criteria.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built a comprehensive MITRE ATT&CK-mapped KQL detection rule library in Microsoft Sentinel, covering over 40 distinct attack techniques and adopted as the standard detection baseline for the security function.
- Scaled CrowdStrike Falcon EDR to over 8,000 endpoints at UAL, delivering full endpoint telemetry and enabling proactive threat hunting at enterprise scale.
- Reduced alert fatigue through targeted detection tuning and SOAR automation, cutting false-positive volumes by more than 30% and improving analyst efficiency.
- Automated key SOC workflows using SOAR, reducing mean time to respond for Tier-1 incidents and enabling the team to handle higher alert volumes without additional headcount.
- Supported successful Cyber Essentials Plus renewal, coordinating cross-team remediation activities within a tight accreditation timeline.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+

- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London / UK)